

ago, “A man is incapable of comprehending any argument that interferes with his revenue.” So of course we must challenge ourselves as to whether the rabbits we are chasing are real.

Contrast businessmen and businesswomen with others who *are* chasing what I believe are the real rabbits of life—physicians and surgeons and nurses, teachers and scientists, sculptors and painters, historians and musicians, authors and poets, jurists and true public servants, ministers and priests and rabbis, and on and on. Perhaps these responsible, dedicated souls earn our respect because they serve our society knowing that accumulating great wealth is almost out of the question, that great fame is rare, and that great power—at least temporal power—is conspicuous by its absence.

But don’t stop there. Think too about the humble folk of this life who do the world’s work—electricians and carpenters, soldiers and firefighters, plumbers and mechanics, computer programmers and train conductors, pilots and navigators, landscapers and stonemasons, technicians and farmers, and on and on. Our society wouldn’t function without these good souls who get up with the sun and do an honest day’s hard work, usually with neither complaint nor accolade, and are rarely rewarded with any of those elusive fruits of so-called success. Yet surely few of them need wonder about whether the rabbits they chase are real. *Of course they are real!*

“I long to accomplish a great and noble task,” the ever-inspiring Helen Keller once wrote, “but it is my chief duty to accomplish humble tasks as though they were great and noble. The world is moved along, not only by the mighty shoves of its heroes, but also by the aggregate of the tiny pushes of each honest worker.”

Woodrow Wilson said it perhaps even more eloquently:

The treasury of America does not lie in the brains of the small body of men now in control of the great enterprises.... It depends upon the inventions, upon the originations, upon the ambitions of unknown men and women. Every country is renewed out of the ranks of the unknown, not out of the ranks of the already famous and powerful in control.